



### World's largest ship

It's over 1300 feet long, close to 200 feet wide, and it's currently being built in Korea <http://dgit.in/1to1t3U>



### The VP from Heaven?

A senior Google VP broke Felix Baumgartner's record for the highest parachute jump. <http://dgit.in/10tbNM9>

# Windows 10

## First Look

### (What we wanted Vs. What we got)

If Windows 8 was a disaster, Windows 8.1 was its saving grace and Windows 10 is set to be the messiah. But has Microsoft really been listening? Can it really meld the functionality of Windows 7 with the power of Windows 8?

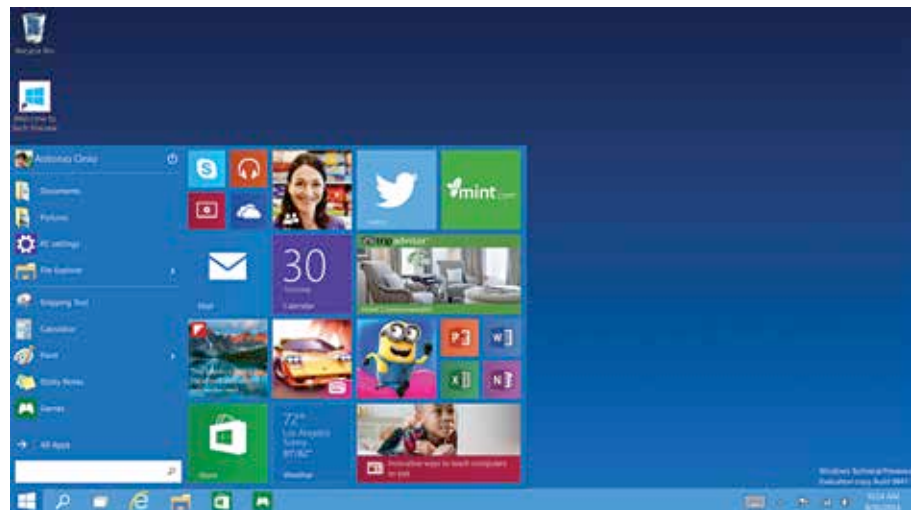
Siddhant Sharma  
[readersletters@digit.in](mailto:readersletters@digit.in)

### Introduction

It's no secret that every alternate version of Microsoft's poster boy - the Windows operating system, bombs miserably. But this time, in a weird twist of fate or rather numbers, Microsoft decided to ditch Windows 9 and directly jump to Windows 10 (please leave numerology out of this). The explanation that they gave for this was that "since there is so much more that the next iteration has to offer, it would be appropriate to name it a complete 10". Not that we care about version numbers, as it's always about what the OS has to offer in general that piques our interest.

We last spoke about what we would like to have in the next version of Windows not too long ago in these very pages, in the April 2013 issue to be precise. Back then, there were quite a lot of loose ends in the OS which made users feel that they weren't exactly working on an OS designed for PC's.

There we covered the gripes that we had with Windows 8 and how Microsoft should go about fixing things in order to make the OS a more complete experience. We were curious to know what changes Microsoft implemented with Windows 10, ensuring that we, the pure PC users, were happy and not feel cheated like we did with Windows 8 and its poorly handled interface. This is why we used our quick ninja reflexes (and a 15Mbps broadband



The new start menu in Windows 10. Oh yes. It's back! How we all missed it, no?

line) to download, install and test the Windows 10 Technical Preview as soon as it came out. So let's find out if the new and upcoming Windows is a perfect 10 or a lonely zero. Is it the game changer that we want it to be?

### 1 To "Start" or not to "Start", that is the question

#### What we wanted

The major issue users had with Windows 8 was primarily with the "Start" menu and the general behaviour of the user interface. The reaction of everyone, including industry pundits, was one of pure horror. This reaction is due to the decision that Microsoft took regarding the UI's design, where they settled for a compromise between a touch-friendly and Desktop-

friendly UI. While the idea was alright in theory, in practice it was a horrendous mess with users ending up with the worst of both worlds. Windows itself couldn't decide on which UI it preferred and Desktop users spent more time juggling with the two UIs than actually using the PC. To add to the confusion, the Metro UI featured different apps from the Desktop UI, making the juggling an even more complex task.

The layout of the start screen was a big turn-off, especially because users wouldn't instantly get what they want as the familiarity of clicking buttons was lost among a grid of tiles which weren't truly intuitive at first.

All we asked of Microsoft was that the OS should focus on a single UI instead of differentiating itself into Desktop mode